# Problem Statement Template · Beginner version

A problem statement template helps you describe a problem clearly before jumping to solutions: who is affected, what happens, where and when, its impact and the outcome you want.

## Problem statement · Describe the problem, not the solution

| Element | Prompt | Your answer |
|---|---|---|
| Who | Who is affected? | Customers updating their account details |
| What | What is the problem? | They must call support to change details |
| Where / when | Where and when does it happen? | Every day, mostly at month-end billing |
| Impact | What does it cost? Quantify. | 3,200 calls a month; 9-minute average handling time |
| Evidence | Data or research that shows it. | Call logs Jan-Mar; customer survey |
| Desired outcome | What does good look like? | Customers self-serve; calls down 30% |
| Constraints | Limits on any solution. | Must use existing billing system |
| Problem statement | Combine into one or two sentences. | Customers cannot update account details online, causing 3,200 support calls a month; we want them to self-serve and cut calls by 30% this year. |
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